

A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns in a dark green color, framing the central text.

BibInVs MN 37

Haggai

*Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 37*

God

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Haggai

Haggai 1

MSG

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- 1 On the first day of the sixth month of the second year in the reign of King Darius of Persia, GOD's Message was delivered by the prophet Haggai to the governor of Judah, Zerubbabel son of Shealtiel, and to the high priest, Joshua son of Jehozadak:
- 1 In the second year of King Darius, on the first day of the sixth month, the word of the LORD came through the prophet Haggai to Zerubbabel son of Shealtiel, governor of Judah, and to Joshua son of Jehozadak, the high priest:
- 2 A Message from GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies: "The people procrastinate. They say this isn't the right time to rebuild my Temple, the Temple of GOD."
- 2 This is what the LORD Almighty says: "These people say, 'The time has not yet come for the LORD's house to be built.'"
- 3 Shortly after that, GOD said more and Haggai spoke it:
- 3 Then the word of the LORD came through the prophet Haggai:
- 4 "How is it that it's the 'right time' for you to live in your fine new homes while the Home, GOD's Temple, is in ruins?"
- 4 Is it a time for you yourselves to be living in your paneled houses, while this house remains a ruin?
- 5 And then a little later, GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies spoke out again: "Take a good, hard look at your life. Think it over.
- 5 Now this is what the LORD Almighty says: "Give careful thought to your ways.
- 6 You have spent a lot of money, but you haven't much to show for it. You keep filling your plates, but you never get filled up. You keep drinking and drinking and drinking, but you're always thirsty. You put on layer after layer of clothes, but you can't get warm. And the people who work

- for you, what are they getting out of it? Not much-- a leaky, rusted-out bucket, that's what.
- 6 You have planted much, but have harvested little. You eat, but never have enough. You drink, but never have your fill. You put on clothes, but are not warm. You earn wages, only to put them in a purse with holes in it."
- 7 That's why GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies said: "Take a good, hard look at your life. Think it over."
- 7 This is what the LORD Almighty says: "Give careful thought to your ways.
- 8 Then GOD said: "Here's what I want you to do: Climb into the hills and cut some timber. Bring it down and rebuild the Temple. Do it just for me. Honor me.
- 8 Go up into the mountains and bring down timber and build the house, so that I may take pleasure in it and be honored," says the LORD.
- 9 You've had great ambitions for yourselves, but nothing has come of it. The little you have brought to my Temple I've blown away--there was nothing to it. "And why?" (This is a Message from GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, remember.) "Because while you've run around, caught up with taking care of your own houses, my Home is in ruins.
- 9 You expected much, but see, it turned out to be little. What you brought home, I blew away. Why? declares the LORD Almighty. "Because of my house, which remains a ruin, while each of you is busy with his own house.
- 10 That's why. Because of your stinginess. And so I've given you a dry summer and a skimpy crop.
- 10 Therefore, because of you the heavens have withheld their dew and the earth its crops.
- 11 I've matched your tight-fisted stinginess by decreeing a season of drought, drying up fields and hills, withering gardens and orchards, stunting vegetables and fruit. Nothing--not man or woman, not animal or crop--is going to thrive."
- 11 I called for a drought on the fields and the mountains, on the grain, the new wine, the oil and whatever the ground produces, on men and cattle, and on the labor of your hands."
- 12 Then the governor, Zerubbabel son of Shealtiel, and the high priest, Joshua son of Jehozadak, and all the people with them listened, really

listened, to the voice of their GOD. When GOD sent the prophet Haggai to them, they paid attention to him. In listening to Haggai, they honored GOD.

12 Then Zerubbabel son of Shealtiel, Joshua son of Jehozadak, the high priest, and the whole remnant of the people obeyed the voice of the LORD their God and the message of the prophet Haggai, because the LORD their God had sent him. And the people feared the LORD.

13 Then Haggai, GOD's messenger, preached GOD's Message to the people: "I am with you!" GOD's Word.

13 Then Haggai, the LORD's messenger, gave this message of the LORD to the people: "I am with you," declares the LORD.

14 This is how GOD got Zerubbabel, Joshua, and all the people moving-- got them working on the Temple of GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies.

14 So the LORD stirred up the spirit of Zerubbabel son of Shealtiel, governor of Judah, and the spirit of Joshua son of Jehozadak, the high priest, and the spirit of the whole remnant of the people. They came and began to work on the house of the LORD Almighty, their God,

15 This happened on the twenty-fourth day of the sixth month in the second year of King Darius.

15 on the twenty- fourth day of the sixth month in the second year of King Darius.

Haggai 2

MSG

NIV

1 On the twenty-first day of the seventh month, the Word of GOD came through the prophet Haggai: "Tell Governor Zerubbabel son of Shealtiel and High Priest Joshua son of Jehozadak

1 On the twenty-first day of the seventh month, the word of the LORD came through the prophet Haggai:

2 and all the people:

2 Speak to Zerubbabel son of Shealtiel, governor of Judah, to Joshua son of Jehozadak, the high priest, and to the remnant of the people. Ask them,

3 'Is there anyone here who saw the Temple the way it used to be, all glorious? And what do you see now? Not much, right?

- 3 'Who of you is left who saw this house in its former glory? How does it look to you now? Does it not seem to you like nothing?
- 4 "'So get to work, Zerubbabel!--GOD is speaking. "'Get to work, Joshua son of Jehozadak--high priest!' "'Get to work, all you people!--GOD is speaking. "'Yes, get to work! For I am with you.' The GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies is speaking!
- 4 But now be strong, O Zerubbabel,' declares the LORD. 'Be strong, O Joshua son of Jehozadak, the high priest. Be strong, all you people of the land,' declares the LORD, 'and work. For I am with you,' declares the LORD Almighty.
- 5 'Put into action the word I covenanted with you when you left Egypt. I'm living and breathing among you right now. Don't be timid. Don't hold back.'
- 5 ' This is what I covenanted with you when you came out of Egypt. And my Spirit remains among you. Do not fear.'
- 6 "This is what GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies said: 'Before you know it, I will shake up sky and earth, ocean and fields.
- 6 This is what the LORD Almighty says: 'In a little while I will once more shake the heavens and the earth, the sea and the dry land.
- 7 And I'll shake down all the godless nations. They'll bring bushels of wealth and I will fill this Temple with splendor.' GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies says so.
- 7 I will shake all nations, and the desired of all nations will come, and I will fill this house with glory,' says the LORD Almighty.
- 8 'I own the silver, I own the gold.' Decree of GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies.
- 8 'The silver is mine and the gold is mine,' declares the LORD Almighty.
- 9 "'This Temple is going to end up far better than it started out, a glorious beginning but an even more glorious finish: a place in which I will hand out wholeness and holiness.' Decree of GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies."
- 9 'The glory of this present house will be greater than the glory of the former house,' says the LORD Almighty. 'And in this place I will grant peace,' declares the LORD Almighty."
- 10 On the twenty-fourth day of the ninth month (again, this was in the second year of Darius), GOD's Message came to Haggai:
- 10 On the twenty-fourth day of the ninth month, in the second year of Darius, the word of the LORD came to the prophet Haggai:

- 11 "GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies speaks: Consult the priests for a ruling.
- 11 This is what the LORD Almighty says: 'Ask the priests what the law says:
- 12 If someone carries a piece of sacred meat in his pocket, meat that is set apart for sacrifice on the altar, and the pocket touches a loaf of bread, a dish of stew, a bottle of wine or oil, or any other food, will these foods be made holy by such contact?' The priests said, "No."
- 12 If a person carries consecrated meat in the fold of his garment, and that fold touches some bread or stew, some wine, oil or other food, does it become consecrated?' " The priests answered, "No."
- 13 Then Haggai said, "How about someone who is contaminated by touching a corpse--if that person touches one of these foods, will it be contaminated?" The priests said, "Yes, it will be contaminated."
- 13 Then Haggai said, "If a person defiled by contact with a dead body touches one of these things, does it become defiled?" "Yes," the priests replied, "it becomes defiled."
- 14 Then Haggai said, "'So, this people is contaminated. Their nation is contaminated. Everything they do is contaminated. Whatever they do for me is contaminated.' GOD says so.
- 14 Then Haggai said, " 'So it is with this people and this nation in my sight,' declares the LORD. 'Whatever they do and whatever they offer there is defiled.
- 15 ""Think back. Before you set out to lay the first foundation stones for the rebuilding of my Temple,
- 15 'Now give careful thought to this from this day on-- consider how things were before one stone was laid on another in the LORD's temple.
- 16 how did it go with you? Isn't it true that your foot-dragging, halfhearted efforts at rebuilding the Temple of GOD were reflected in a sluggish, halfway return on your crops--half the grain you were used to getting, half the wine?
- 16 When anyone came to a heap of twenty measures, there were only ten. When anyone went to a wine vat to draw fifty measures, there were only twenty.
- 17 I hit you with drought and blight and hail. Everything you were doing got hit. But it didn't seem to faze you. You continued to ignore me.' GOD's Decree.

- 17 I struck all the work of your hands with blight, mildew and hail, yet you did not turn to me,' declares the LORD.
- 18 "'Now think ahead from this same date--this twenty-fourth day of the ninth month. Think ahead from when the Temple rebuilding was launched.
- 18 'From this day on, from this twenty-fourth day of the ninth month, give careful thought to the day when the foundation of the LORD's temple was laid. Give careful thought:
- 19 Has anything in your fields--vine, fig tree, pomegranate, olive tree--failed to flourish? From now on you can count on a blessing.'"
- 19 Is there yet any seed left in the barn? Until now, the vine and the fig tree, the pomegranate and the olive tree have not borne fruit. " 'From this day on I will bless you.' "
- 20 GOD's Message came a second time to Haggai on that most memorable day, the twenty-fourth day of the ninth month:
- 20 The word of the LORD came to Haggai a second time on the twenty-fourth day of the month:
- 21 "Speak to Zerubbabel, the governor of Judah: "'I am about to shake up everything, to turn everything upside down and start over from top to bottom--
- 21 Tell Zerubbabel governor of Judah that I will shake the heavens and the earth.
- 22 overthrow governments, destroy foreign powers, dismantle the world of weapons and armaments, throw armies into confusion, so that they end up killing one another.
- 22 I will overturn royal thrones and shatter the power of the foreign kingdoms. I will overthrow chariots and their drivers; horses and their riders will fall, each by the sword of his brother.
- 23 And on that day'"--this is GOD's Message--"'I will take you, O Zerubbabel son of Shealtiel, as my personal servant and I will set you as a signet ring, the sign of my sovereign presence and authority. I've looked over the field and chosen you for this work.'" The Message of GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies.
- 23 'On that day,' declares the LORD Almighty, 'I will take you, my servant Zerubbabel son of Shealtiel,' declares the LORD, 'and I will make you

like my signet ring, for I have chosen you,' declares the LORD Almighty.